Ask before it acts

AI agents · Lower secondary · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Sort actions into read only, ask first, allowed and never.
- Read the exact action before you say yes.
- Write a Python check that sends only after a yes.

Key ideas

- Reading is low risk; acting needs your yes.
- A model’s asking is learned, and can fail.
- The app checks the yes in code, and keeps a record.

Permission sort

1. Warm-up (3 min): Name one action you could never undo.
2. Sort (7 min): Twelve action cards, four labels.
3. Argue (6 min): Agree on the hardest three cards.
4. Code (4 min): Trace the yes check on paper.

Write the action cards before you start. Use only made-up names: never a real person’s message or photo.

Let’s discuss

1. Which actions would you never let an agent do, even with a yes?
2. Why isn’t the model’s polite question enough?
3. What should an app’s record of actions show?

Exit ticket

- Write one action for each level: read only, ask first, allowed, never.